

This listing of claims will replace all prior versions, and listings, of claims in the application:

Listing of claims

1. (Canceled)
2. (Canceled)
3. (Previously presented) The telecommunication system of claim 8, wherein the brokerage server communicates with the payer via a secure session over the telecommunication network using a hand-held payer electronic device.
4. (Previously presented) The telecommunication system of claim 8, wherein the brokerage server communicates with the payee via a secure session over the telecommunication network using a payee electronic device.
5. (Previously presented) The telecommunication system of claim 8, wherein the brokerage server database comprises a plurality of records for payers and payees, each payer record comprising authentication information and at least one funding source and one real account associated with the payer, and each payee record comprises at least identification information associated with the payee and at least one financial institution and at least one real account associated with the payee.
6. (Canceled)
7. (Canceled)
8. (Previously presented) A telecommunication system comprising:
 - a) an electronic communication device connected to and configured for communication over a telecommunication network, the electronic device comprising:

a device communication facility permitting communication over the telecommunication network via a secure session; and

a processor configured for running a secure application for (i) authenticating or obtaining authentication information from a payer, (ii) communicating via secure sessions and accessing secure databases, (iii) receiving payee identifying and real account and financial institution information, (iv) receiving a selection by the payer of a funding source and at least one real account associated with the payer, and (v) receiving a selection by the payer of at least one real account and financial institution associated with the payee;

b) a brokerage server, operated by a payment broker and connected to and configured for communication over the telecommunication network, the brokerage server comprising:

a server communication facility permitting communication over the telecommunication network via a secure session;

a computer memory comprising a secure database; and

a processor configured for (i) receiving authentication information via the telecommunication network using the server communication facility, (ii) authenticating and identifying the payer based on the authentication information, (iii) receiving, via the telecommunication network using the server communication facility, an instruction from the payer instructing that a payment be made electronically from the payer-selected funding source and at least one payer-selected real account thereof to a payer-selected real account and financial institution, other than the payment broker, associated with the payee, the selection of the real account and financial institution associated with the payee being controlled by the payer and not by the payee, (iv) computationally retrieving, from the secure database, information identifying the payer-selected funding source and the at least one payer-selected real account thereof and the payee and the payer-selected real account of the payee at a financial institution other than the payment broker, (v) requesting, via the telecommunication network using the server communication facility, the server of the payer-selected funding source to authorize the payment to the payee, (vi) if the payment is authorized by the server of the payer-selected funding source, instructing such server, via the telecommunication network using the server communication facility, to cause the payment to be made electronically to the payee on the funding source's behalf by a third party other than the payment broker such that the identities of the payer-selected

funding source and the at least one payer-selected real account of the payer at the funding source are not divulged to the payee and such real-account identifying information is not transmitted to, received or stored by the payee's depository bank or other financial institution, and (vii) instructing the server of the payer-selected funding source, via the telecommunication network using the server communication facility, to reimburse or transfer the amount of the payment to the third party from the at least one payer-selected real account of the payer at the funding source; and

c) a funding source server, operated by a payer-selected funding source and connected to and configured for communication over the telecommunication network, the funding source server comprising:

a server communication facility permitting communication over the telecommunication network;

a computer memory comprising a secure database; and

a processor configured for (i) receiving, via the telecommunication network using the server communication facility, the request from the payment broker server for authorization of the payment, (ii) computationally retrieving, from a secure database, information identifying the payer and the at least one payer-selected real account of the payer at the funding source, (iii) authorizing or denying the requested payment, (iv) in response to instruction from the payment broker server following authorization, instructing, via the telecommunication network using the server communication facility, at least one third party other than the payment broker to make the payment electronically to the payee from a real account of the third party at a financial institution associated with the third party and in the third party's name and not in the name of the payment broker, the funding source or the payer, thereby preventing divulgence, both to the payee's depository bank or financial institution and to the payee, of the identity of the funding source and the at least one payer-selected real account of the payer, and (v) reimbursing or transferring the amount of the payment to the third party from the at least one payer-selected real account of the payer at the funding source.